Once upon a time the cat the mouse and the rabbit wer
e out walking in a big green field the sun was shini
ng and the moon was high in the sky. mind the glass, the cat
said to the rabbit, as they crossed a field. the cows paid no
attention to them. as they walked a crow flew up to them, and
they all stopped for a while for a little chat.
my lover has died, said the little mouse.
what should i do?
perhaps we should have a picnic, the
cat said, and th
ey all agreed that this was the right
thing to do.
over the next hill they saw a big tree
so off they all headed, the cat the mouse
the rabbit and their new friend the crow.
Under the shade of the big white oak tree they all sat and
ate and pondered and soon the sun had set and darkness fell
all around. under the light of the fire they all rested,
the cat the mouse the rabbit and the crow and the big white
oak tree on the hill far away. soon they had all fallen
asleep, huddled up and breathing lightly. this is what they
dreamt...
the mouse slept at home under thick woolen
sheets. its little mouse room under the stairs, with its
little mouse candle burning faintly in its little mouse
corner. mouse demons and mouse angel s pass through the room
and stop for a little cheese left out for them.

the cat sits on a wide
yellow beach sunning its self and wat
ching the waves crash and roll at its
feet. how i wish i had remembered th
e sun cream the cat thought, licking
its hot paws...

the rabbit did not dre
am. it just sat there quite still and
peaceful, occasionally wrinkling its
nose should a fly buzz too close and tickle it.
after a while however it did dream, and it dreamt it
was a little brown soft-toy rabbit, its long
soft toy ears blowing in a cool soft toy-land wind.

this little group all quiet,
excepting the occasional snore or a l
oud sqwark from the crow. who knows w
hat the crow was dreaming...perhaps
it never even slept, but no one thoug
ht to ask so we will never know.
perhaps it just always remained a
crow perhaps even crows sleep sometimes
perhaps they even dream

they liked the tree on the hill so much they stayed for a long while. there was a beautiful view it is true, and no one seemed to mind them being there, the cat the mouse the crow and the rabbit

after a while however the tree died and could no longer provi de shelter, but the fields had grown, what with all the rain and sun, and alone now on the dead tree hill they couldn't se e anything for miles. even the cows had gone home.a plan was decided and this was that the brave crow should fly up and ov er into the green distance and spy a place to go, or perhaps bump into someone who could lead them all home. the cat was getting a bit hungry and missed its cat food, and the rabbit missed its other rabbit friends. the mouse was quiet, sitting alone nibbling the last of the cheese it had brought.

so off the crow flew into the sunning blue sky. sure enough after a while it met a seagull, and they stopped on a cloud for a chat. my friends have sent me out to find home, said th e crow, because the green field has grown so much we cannot see the way out. the seagull listened sadly to what the crow said, and remained quiet for a long while after.
it is the same everywhere, it said. everything has grown everywhere i go, it must have been the sun and the rain we ha ve had.

no sooner had these words been spoken when
the sky turned black and fierce. the sun cracked and lightening streaked the heavens. the storm raged above and below, sweeping across the green fields and peaceful pastures. in the winds the crow and the seagull were blown apart and carried far apart and swept and battered by the cold rains.
what of my friends,thought the crow as it tumbled through the sky, all alone and unsheltered on that lonely green hill far below.

the storm passed soon enough, but the damage had been done. when crow returned to its friends on the hill they were all quite still and motionless. crow sat by them and could only wait.

Presently the cat stirred. all wet and covered in tar from the storm, it saw crow and weakly told of what had happened.

rabbit has died, my friend crow, it said. the storm was too hard and cold and it lasted too long for the softness of rabbit. rabbit has died and there is just me.

but what of little mouse, said the crow. has mouse died too? i cannot say said the cat. the winds cut too low for mouse to keep firm, and my fur was too wet to shield ... poor mouse was too weak and was blown over

tumbling over the edge

in the sun after the storm these two figures set off the hill to search for their lost friend mouse, cat and crow walking side by side, crow flying further on from now and then, soon returning to cat's side to continue onwards

into the green

green

and it is now we leave them,
cat and crow and mouse

somewhere

what will become of them?

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a house somewhere a muddy village of straw a
nd mud dried in the sun which is shining
but there are no people out on the mu
d streets everything is almost still
a house somewhere inside where a small
straw fire simmers under small mud roof
the room is quite still and empty
a mud floor
dried in the mud heat and a bed in the
corner upon which
there are small things on the walls in the
mud shadows
they glisten and hang still
lovers momentos and found things kept
and hung
plain mudded treasures
but air is still with sickness
mud air in a small
mud house in a small
mud village whose
streets are empty in
the mud sunshine

enter the house hear small breathing
weak small breath under straw sheets in
the bed in the mud corner dried and in shadow

small weak body of a small animal

who does not think
where it is
in mud house in sun
resting small weak animal in deepness
under small mud roof dried under healing sun

there is just this and we do not know
where it is

mud
house
straw sheets
and small clean weak body

small unconscious body washed up
on muddy bank
children playing
find small weak body of animal washed up on the stream bank a
small little death but they gently pick it up and wrap in
warm straw
and take almost inert body of small little weakness
back across the field to their village and everyone
gathers around
and they lie small animal found wet and still in wet mud of
small stream quite still in the childrens house
and light a small fire to heal the air in this small
childrens house in their mud village

which is now quite still and empty
all the villagers and children
have gone
the streets are almost quiet
but quite empty
the children will never come back
but the small mud houses will always
be there, almost still in the mud sun

and when mouse wakes up again and is healed from its
little muddy death, it will put out the small straw fire
and re-straw the small mud bed in the corner
and walk out of this little mud house
and walk down these small almost
still mud streets and leave this
village

cross the field to the stream

wash in the clear water then co
ntinue over a little bridge
into another field

with a small parcel of cheese for food

on into this field alone

as if with some purpose
thinking of its old friends cat and crow
and rabbit far away
but mouse knows in its little mouse heart
that it will never see them again
cat and crow and rabbit
and this makes mouse sad
a small little mouse sadness
but it does not stop or turn
because the village is empty and still
and mouse misses its home
under the stairs
the little mouse candle still burning
in its little mouse corner
still